MANU BHAKER 22
Pistol Shooter

SHOOTING QUEEN

Manu Bhaker scripted a classic turnaround at Paris 2024, putting the ghosts of the past behind her through sheer willpower to engrave her own destiny

By Suhani Singh

In recent years, the hunting has been good, the posse of young Indians who have arrived on the global stage toting their guns, lighting up shooting ranges across the world. Yet, there's been a blip in that upbeat narrative—they underperformed at the most important event of all. Abhinav Bindra's gold at Beijing 2008 had set a new benchmark. But for two consecutive Olympics thereafter, India's shooting squad misfired so much that expectations were modest from the young shooters bound for the 2024 Paris Games. Manu



Picture of Contentment Manu Bhaker with the bronze medal in the 10 metre air pistol event at the Paris Olympics

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